

UAE Labour Aid — NGO, Embassy & Routing Directory

For use as static routing data in the AI legal-aid agent's Routing Agent. All contacts must be verified before production use — phone numbers and services change. Last research date: June 2026.

1. MOHRE — Primary Official Channels

MOHRE (Ministry of Human Resources and Emiratization) is the mandatory first stop for any mainland private-sector labour complaint. Direct court access without MOHRE mediation is legally barred.

Channel	Contact / URL	Use For
MOHRE Main Call Centre	600 590000 (24 hours)	General queries, complaint status, guidance
MOHRE Toll-Free Labour Complaints	800 0600	Filing and tracking labour complaints
MOHRE Labour Claims & Advisory	800 084	Advice on claims, entitlements queries
MOHRE Verified WhatsApp Channel	Check mohre.gov.ae for current number	Quick queries; not for formal filing
MOHRE E-Services Portal	mohre.gov.ae (Labour Complaints section)	Online complaint filing, document upload
MOHRE Smart App	Available on App Store / Google Play (search MOHRE)	Mobile complaint filing and tracking
MOHRE Typing Centres	Available in all emirates — list at mohre.gov.ae	On-person filing assistance

2. Free Zone Employment — Routing Logic

MOHRE jurisdiction applies to mainland UAE private-sector employment ONLY. Workers employed by companies registered in the following financial free zones must be routed to their own separate employment tribunals:

2.1 Dubai International Financial Centre (DIFC)

Channel	Contact / URL
DIFC Employment Standards Office	difc.ae/doing-business/regulations/employment
DIFC Courts Small Claims Tribunal	difccourts.ae — claims up to USD 200,000
DIFC Courts General Filing	difccourts.ae/e-litigation
Phone	+971 4 362 6161 (DIFC Authority)

DIFC has its own Employment Law (DIFC Law No. 4 of 2021). Workers with DIFC-registered employers do NOT use MOHRE and should NOT be directed to MOHRE complaint channels.

2.2 Abu Dhabi Global Market (ADGM)

Channel	Contact / URL
ADGM Employment Regulations Portal	adgm.com/en/adgm/regulations/employment
ADGM Courts	adgmcourts.com
ADGM Registration Authority	+971 2 333 8888

How the Routing Agent should identify free zone workers:

Ask the user for their employer's trade licence type or emirate. If the user mentions DIFC, ADGM, route away from MOHRE. Other free zones (Jafza, DMCC, Media City, etc.) generally fall under MOHRE for employment disputes but may have internal HR channels — when in doubt, confirm with MOHRE's call centre.

3. Embassy Contacts — Major Migrant Worker Nationalities

Migrant workers whose employer holds their passport, threatens visa cancellation, or creates safety risks should be directed to their embassy as a parallel route alongside MOHRE. Embassies can provide emergency travel documents, repatriation assistance, and referrals to legal aid.

VERIFY all numbers at the official embassy websites before using in production — embassy contact details change periodically.

Country	Embassy Location	Labour / Consular Contact	Website
India	Abu Dhabi	Labour helpline (verify at in.embassy.gov.ae)	in.embassy.gov.ae
India (Consulate)	Dubai	CGI Dubai consular services	cgidubai.gov.in
Pakistan	Abu Dhabi	Pakistan Embassy Abu Dhabi consular section	pakembassyuae.com
Pakistan (Consulate)	Dubai	Pakistan Consulate Dubai	pakistanconsuladubai.org
Bangladesh	Abu Dhabi	Bangladesh Embassy Abu Dhabi	bdembassyuae.org
Philippines	Abu Dhabi	POLO-OWWA Abu Dhabi (Overseas Workers Welfare Office)	dubai.dfa.gov.ph
Philippines (Consulate)	Dubai	POLO-OWWA Dubai	dubai.dfa.gov.ph
Nepal	Abu Dhabi	Embassy of Nepal Abu Dhabi	nepalembassyuae.com
Sri Lanka	Abu Dhabi	Sri Lanka Bureau of Foreign Employment	slbfe.lk / embassy contacts
Egypt	Abu Dhabi	Egyptian Embassy Abu Dhabi consular section	Verify at mofa.gov.eg
Indonesia	Abu Dhabi	KJRI Abu Dhabi / BP2MI labour attache	abudhabi.kemlu.go.id
Ethiopia	Abu Dhabi	Ethiopian Embassy Abu Dhabi	Verify at mofa.gov.et
Kenya	Abu Dhabi	Kenyan Embassy Abu Dhabi	Verify at mfa.go.ke

4. NGO, Legal Aid and Support Organisations

The following organisations provide free or low-cost legal guidance, emergency shelter, or advocacy for workers in the UAE. Always verify operational status before routing users — NGO services and funding can change.

4.1 International Organisations Present in UAE

Organisation	Focus Area	Contact / URL
International Labour Organization (ILO)	UAE office: labour standards, issues, etc.	iloesa@ilo.org (regional office covers UAE)
International Organization for Migration (IOM)	Worker welfare, repatriation assistance	u.ae@iom.int
UN Women UAE	Gender-based workplace discrimination, women workers	u.ae@unwomen.org

4.2 UAE Government Worker Support Channels

Channel	Purpose	Contact
National Human Trafficking Hotline (NHTH)	Reports of forced labour, trafficking, confinement	800 HUMAN (800-48626) — 24 hrs
Dubai Foundation for Women and Children (DFWC)	Shelter and support for abuse victims including domestic workers	800 1011 (24 hrs)
Abu Dhabi Family Development Foundation (ADFF)	Family and welfare support in Abu Dhabi	800-ADFF (800-2333)
Ewaa Shelter (Abu Dhabi)	Emergency shelter for vulnerable workers including domestic workers	Visit DF or police
MOHRE Labour Inspection Department	Report unsafe working conditions, labour camps	600 526006 / mohre.gov.ae

4.3 Domestic Worker Specific Channels

Domestic workers are governed by Federal Decree-Law No. 9 of 2022 (not FDL 33/2021) and have separate complaint channels:

- MOHRE handles domestic worker complaints but under a separate track — explicitly state 'domestic worker' when calling or filing online.
- Domestic workers with employment contracts through recruitment agencies may also raise complaints with the agency under MOHRE's agency oversight framework.
- The National Committee to Combat Human Trafficking (NCCHT) handles trafficking and forced-labour reports for domestic workers: 800HUMAN.
- DFWAC (800 111) in Dubai provides emergency shelter and coordinates with MOHRE for domestic worker cases.
- A domestic worker who leaves their employer's premises due to abuse or non-payment should report to the nearest police station or MOHRE within 48 hours to avoid being classified as 'absconding'.

5. Visa and Residency Implications During a Labour Dispute

This section is critical for migrant workers. Workers are often unaware of their residency rights during and after a dispute — misinformation here can deter people from filing legitimate complaints.

5.1 Filing a Complaint Does NOT Cancel Your Visa

- Filing a labour complaint with MOHRE does not automatically cancel a worker's residency visa or work permit.
- An employer cannot unilaterally cancel a worker's visa while a formal MOHRE dispute or court case is pending — doing so constitutes a procedural violation and the worker can report it to MOHRE immediately.
- If an employer attempts to file an 'absconding' report against a worker who has already filed a complaint with MOHRE, the worker should ensure MOHRE has a record of the complaint filing date — this date establishes that the worker did not abandon their employment.

5.2 Temporary Work Permit During Active Dispute

- A worker with an active MOHRE case (referral letter or pending mediation) may apply for a Temporary Work Permit from MOHRE.
- This permit is valid for 6 months and is renewable until the dispute is resolved.
- It is granted without the original employer's consent.
- Requirement: a valid MOHRE referral letter or active court case file number.
- The permit allows the worker to take new employment legally while the dispute proceeds.

5.3 After a MOHRE Decision or Court Judgment

- Once a final judgment is issued, the worker must cancel their original work permit within 14 days of judgment to regularise their residency status.
- If the worker won the case and is owed wages: the enforcement division can seize employer assets; the worker does not have to leave the UAE pending enforcement.
- If the worker wishes to leave the UAE after winning: they should ensure all dues are paid or a judgment is in hand before departing — collecting enforcement payments from abroad is significantly harder.
- Workers who were on sponsored visas and won the right to transfer employers: the new employer handles the visa transfer; the MOHRE referral letter facilitates this process.

5.4 Passport Confiscation (Illegal)

An employer holding a worker's passport is an illegal act under UAE law. Workers in this situation should:

- Report the passport confiscation to MOHRE by calling 600 590000 or filing at mohre.gov.ae — this is a standalone reportable violation separate from any wage complaint.

- Contact their embassy (Section 3 above) who can issue an Emergency Travel Document if needed for repatriation or movement.
- If physical safety is at risk: contact the National Human Trafficking Hotline (800HUMAN) — passport confiscation combined with movement restriction is a trafficking indicator triggering HIGH_RISK routing in the agent.

This document is a reference guide for an AI legal-aid system. It is not legal advice. All contact details must be independently verified before use in a live system. Last research date: June 2026.